Assignment 7: Phonetics

Ling 201 – Fall 2026

(100 pts total)

Please **do not use external sources such as the internet or AI to find the answers**. If you need an **extension**, please ask before the deadline. **General American pronunciation is assumed here**.

Part 1. English Consonants Identifying

Identify the **first consonants** in the given English words and provide the IPA symbol and the description (voicing, place, and manner) for it. *(3 points/item, 24 points total)*

example *dental* [d] voiced alveolar stop

1. vote
2. this
3. germ
4. note
5. shock
6. hair
7. gone
8. yellow

Part 2. English Vowel Identifying

Identify **the vowels** in the given English words and provide the IPA symbol and the description (height, backness, and roundedness) for it. *(2 points/item, 12 points total)*

example *can* [æ] front low unrounded

1. sit
2. more
3. booth
4. set
5. book
6. say

Part 3. Phonetic Transcription: IPA to English

Translate the following IPA transcriptions into English spelling. *(1 points/item, 10 points total)*

example [kənfjuʒn̩] confusion

1. [wɛnzdej] →
2. [θɑwzn̩d] →
3. [ɹʌtgəɹs] →
4. [hɛzətejt] →
5. [bejðiŋsut] →
6. [kjukʌmbɻ] →
7. [pʰɪlgɹɪm] →
8. [ælfəbɛɾɪk] →
9. [bajlɪŋgwəl] →
10. [kɑnsənənt] →

Part 4. Phonetic Transcription: English to IPA

Provide the phonetic transcription for the given English words. *(2 points/item, 24 points total, question 9 and 10 count as 2 items)*

example *can* [kæn] (Don't forget the brackets!)

1. hit →
2. vet →
3. hood →
4. wedge →
5. think →
6. who →
7. party →
8. wing →
9. Facebook →
10. Snow White →

Part 5. Sound Classes

For each description, mark all of the given IPA symbols that fit the description on the left (the number of correct answers may vary by question). Only consider symbols on the same line as the description. *(15 points total)*

1. voiced velars	[v]	[g]	[r]	[ð]	[ŋ]	[ɣ]	[k]
2. low (open) vowels	[i]	[ə]	[æ]	[o]	[ɑ]	[ɛ]	[y]
3. voiced stops/plosives	[ɢ]	[t]	[b]	[ɱ]	[h]	[ɻ]	[d]
4. alveolars	[n]	[s]	[β]	[θ]	[ɹ]	[ʁ]	[x]
5. rounded vowels	[æ]	[ɛ]	[ʊ]	[ɪ]	[o]	[e]	[u]

Part 6. Reading Sentences in IPA

Write the following broad phonetic transcriptions in regular English spelling. *(5 points/item, 15 points total)*

1. fənɛtɪks ɪz ðə stʌdi əv spitʃ saʊndz

2. sʌm pipəl θɪŋk fənɛtɪks ɪz vɛɹi ɪntəɹəstɪŋ

3. ɔl spoʊkən læŋgwɪdʒəz juz saʊndz pɹədjust baj ðə ʌpəɹ ɹɛspəɹətɔɹi sɪstəm

Extra Credit

This part is **optional**. If you attempt it, you will receive *at least 1 extra point* on top of your grade. Up to ***5 points*** may be awarded based on the quality of your answer. *(5 points)*

Write a phonetic transcription for each of the ***italicised words*** in the following excerpt of a poem entitled ***Brush Up Your English*** published long ago in a British newspaper.

I take it you already ***know***

Of ***tough*** and ***bough*** and ***cough*** and ***dough***?

Some may stumble, but not you,

On ***hiccough***, ***thorough***, ***slough*** and ***through***?

…

A ***moth*** is not a moth in ***mother***,

Nor ***both*** in ***bother***, ***broth*** in ***brother***.